

Expressions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Cultures, Grade 9

Open (NAC10)

OVERVIEW

“Expressions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Cultures” focuses on both art appreciation and art creation. It allows students to analyse First Nations, Métis, and Inuit works in the various arts and, acting ethically and responsibly, to create art works and/or productions that integrate aspects of these disciplines. This course encourages creative expression and fosters the development of skills and knowledge that prepare students for lifelong learning and participation in the arts and arts-related activities. Students will explore creative challenges through the use of elements, principles, materials, techniques, and tools associated with two or more arts disciplines, including dance, drama, media arts, music, and visual arts. Students also explore the functions of, influences on, and impact of art works from various disciplines and from several different First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures.

Art making is central to many Indigenous cultures, often, though not exclusively, as a means to communicate cultural and spiritual values. While art works have aesthetic qualities, their aesthetic purpose may be no more significant than their spiritual, cultural, or material function. Dance and song, for example, can be understood not only as arts disciplines but also as cultural text forms whose purpose may be to promote healing, express reverence, or settle disputes. Similarly, beadwork is an art form with aesthetic value, but its use on traditional clothing may also communicate the wearer’s spiritual identity. Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists often, though not exclusively, use art as a means to communicate political and social messages, to affirm individual or collective Indigenous identity, and/or to express and promote cultural renewal.

The art forms, genres, styles, and techniques taught in NAC10 are rooted in richly diverse First Nations, Métis, and Inuit histories, perspectives, and cultures. They represent various ways of knowing and different forms of communication, providing students with opportunities to develop their understanding of the artistic languages used in art forms from these cultures, as well as to communicate that understanding. The various arts disciplines are therefore a vital component of literacy education, promoting literacies that contribute to students’ ability to explore, negotiate, communicate, interpret, and make sense of the changing realities of contemporary culture and society. Education in First Nations, Métis,

and Inuit arts not only deepens students' understanding and appreciation of Indigenous art making, both past and present, but also prepares them to be active participants in bringing about social change by supporting reconciliation and promoting mutually respectful relationships.

STRANDS

The expectations in NAC10 are organized into four distinct but related strands:

A. Artistic Expression and First Nations, Métis, and Inuit World Views

Students develop their understanding of how various art forms and arts disciplines are used to express and reflect the key concept areas associated with First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures: relationships, identities, and self-determination.

B. Creating and Presenting

Students apply the creative process (see page 65) to create art works/productions using materials and elements and/or principles from one or more arts disciplines. Students use technologies, tools, and techniques associated with these disciplines to create, modify, present, and promote art works/productions ethically and responsibly, drawing on their exploration of diverse Indigenous perspectives while respecting cultural protocols.

C. Foundations

In this strand, students use the critical analysis process (see page 65) to develop their understanding of and appreciation for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit works from various arts disciplines, and learn to use appropriate terminology to refer to elements, principles, and other key concepts related to those disciplines. Students explore past and present themes and influences in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art making, as well as conventions and ethical considerations (e.g., cultural protocols, permission, cultural appropriation) associated with creating and experiencing different types of art works/productions.

D. Art and Society

In this strand, students develop their understanding of and appreciation for the historical and contemporary social contexts of a variety of Indigenous art forms. Students examine the role of art in promoting renewal and healing in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities and reconciliation in dialogue with non-Indigenous communities, generating a deeper understanding of themselves and the communities in which they live.

KEY PROCESSES IN THE ARTS

Key processes are described in detail, with accompanying graphics and discussions of other relevant topics, in *The Ontario Curriculum, Grades 9 and 10: The Arts, 2010*. What follows below is a brief discussion of the key processes in the context of the present course. Teachers will find it helpful to consult the broader discussions provided in the front matter of the arts curriculum document.

Students use the creative and critical analysis processes, which involve critical thinking and inquiry skills and processes, to develop their ability to resolve artistic challenges and respond meaningfully to the artistic productions of others.

The Creative Process

Students are expected to learn and use the creative process to help them acquire and apply knowledge and skills in the arts. Use of the creative process is to be integrated with use of the critical analysis process as students work to achieve the expectations in the four strands.

Creativity involves innovation: developing new thinking and integrating it with existing knowledge. Sometimes the creative process is more about asking the right questions than about finding the right answer. Teachers need to create a learning atmosphere that encourages both spontaneity and deliberate, focused effort to help students cultivate creativity as they develop the skills involved in art making. A setting that is conducive to creativity is one in which students are not afraid to suggest alternative ideas and take risks.

The creative process comprises several stages:

- challenging and inspiring
- imagining and generating
- planning and focusing
- exploring and experimenting
- producing preliminary work
- revising and refining
- presenting and performing
- reflecting and evaluating

As students and teachers become increasingly familiar with the creative process, they are able to move consciously between the stages in a flexible and cyclical manner, varying the order of the stages as appropriate. For example, students may benefit from exploring and experimenting before planning and focusing.

Students will sometimes complete all the stages of the creative process; at other times they may reach only the exploration and experimentation stage, which research clearly shows is critical in the development of creative thinking skills. Students should be encouraged to experiment ethically and responsibly with a wide range of materials, tools, techniques, and conventions, and should be given numerous opportunities to explore and manipulate the elements of each art form.

Ongoing feedback and structured opportunities for students to engage in reflection are woven into each stage of the creative process. Assessment by both teacher and student is used to enhance students' creativity and support their development and achievement in the arts. As students progress through the process of solving an artistic problem, communication and reflection help them to see the problem from different perspectives and to articulate and refine their thinking in response.

The Critical Analysis Process

The critical analysis process involves critical thinking: questioning, evaluating, making rational judgements, finding logical connections, and categorizing. Critical thinking also requires openness to other points of view, including the rich diversity of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives. Students need to be taught that works of art are not created in a vacuum; they reflect the personal, cultural, social, and historical context of the artists.

Using the critical analysis process will enable students to:

- respond knowledgeably and sensitively to their own works, those of their peers, and works created by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists in different arts disciplines;
- make connections between their own experience and art works/productions, between different art forms, and between the art and lives of Indigenous individuals and communities;
- interpret how the elements of each art form contribute to meaning in works in dance, drama, media arts, music, and visual arts created by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists;
- develop, share, and justify an informed point of view about Indigenous art works/productions;
- demonstrate awareness of and appreciation for the importance of Indigenous dance, drama, media arts, music, and visual arts in society;
- demonstrate appreciation appropriately as audience members in formal and informal settings, including settings focused on Indigenous art works/productions (e.g., at peer performances and in community spaces, arts institutions, galleries, concert halls, and theatres).

Teachers can set the stage for critical response and analysis by creating a culturally safe and reassuring learning environment in which students feel free to experiment with new or alternative approaches and ideas. This is a good opportunity to remind students that different people may respond to the same work in different ways. While students may lack background information about specific Indigenous artists, aspects of art history, and contemporary artistic practices, their own life experience, knowledge of Indigenous perspectives, intuition, ideas, and critical and creative thinking abilities are important and relevant.

The critical analysis process includes the following aspects:

- initial reaction
- analysis and interpretation
- consideration of cultural context
- expression of aesthetic judgement
- ongoing reflection

Initial Reaction

If students cannot easily explain their first impressions, teachers can ask questions such as the following to help them move beyond overly simple value judgements:

- What image, idea, or event does this work bring to mind?
- What does this movement suggest to you?
- What emotions do you feel as you experience this work?
- What puzzles you? What would you like to ask the artist?
- What does this work remind you of in your own experience?
- How do you think this work is connected to other art forms?

Students need to be reassured that there are no wrong answers if their responses are sincere.

Analysis and Interpretation

As part of analysis, students try to figure out what an artist has done to achieve certain effects. Students might want to refer back to their first impressions, such as an impression of liveliness, and then analyse how the artist's use of the elements, principles, materials, and/or concepts specific to the art form provoked their response. Teachers should encourage students to describe and explain how the individual elements have been used and how they relate to each other. Students can also analyse the overall characteristics and compositional features of the work (e.g., how the artist uses and manipulates various sounds, movements, or images).

As students move towards interpretation they connect their new learning about Indigenous perspectives, identities, and experiences with the characteristics found in the art work. This stage requires the use of higher-order thinking skills, as students go beyond free association to combine associations based on evidence found in the work. As in the "initial reaction" stage, there are no wrong answers.

Activities such as discussing interpretations in a small group, writing an artist's statement, keeping a reflective journal, working independently on a written analysis, or preparing notes for an oral presentation or a visit with an Indigenous artist may all be part of this stage.

Sample guiding questions might include:

- What did you intend to communicate in your art work/production, and why?
- What elements, principles, and/or conventions of the art form are used in this work by a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit musician, fashion designer, illustrator, choreographer, playwright, media artist, or visual artist?
- In what ways did the artist select and combine elements of Indigenous histories, perspectives, or cultures in this work? How can you assess whether the artist's process was ethical and responsible?
- What is the theme, subject, or message of the work?
- Why do you think the artist created this work?
- What cultural, political, social, or personal view of the world do you think the artist has?
- How does this view match or contrast with your own view of the world?

The types of questions asked will vary with the art works/productions being discussed.

Consideration of Cultural Context

As part of the critical analysis process, students develop an understanding of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit works of art in their cultural context. Students need to understand how artists' cultural, spiritual, and individual identities, as well as aspects of their personal lives, can shape their work.

Sample guiding questions might include:

- How has the artist's cultural or spiritual identity influenced this work?
- What artistic traditions of the artist's Indigenous community can you identify in this work?
- What events in the artist's life may have affected the creation of the work?

Students may also conduct their own inquiry-based research to extend their understanding of art works/productions in context, or teachers can support them in investigations into the following:

- the similarities and differences between historical and contemporary art works/productions from the same cultural group
- examples of other works created by artists from the same cultural group
- the initial reception of the work by Indigenous and non-Indigenous critics and audiences
- the responsibility of an audience, including the individual's responsibility to acknowledge any personal or cultural biases that may influence their response to a work

Expression of Aesthetic Judgement

Students compare their perception of the art work after reflection and analysis to their initial reaction and make connections to other art works/productions they have experienced.

Sample guiding questions might include:

- How effectively does the artist select and combine elements to achieve an intended effect in this work?
- In your opinion, what doesn't work, and why?
- Has your point of view shifted from your initial reaction? If so, how and why has it changed?
- In what ways does the artist evoke joy, sadness, resilience, or other emotions in this work?

Ongoing Reflection

Reflection occurs throughout the critical analysis process, whether students are examining their own works or the works of others.

Sample guiding questions to help students in reflecting on a work of their own might include:

- In what ways do you think your work is successful?
- How did you ethically and respectfully incorporate new learning into your work? What Indigenous cultural protocols did you follow, and how did that influence your work?
- In what ways would you change the work to improve it?
- How did your work affect the audience? Was it the way you intended?
- How would you alter this work for a different audience, or to send a different message?

Expressions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Cultures, Grade 9

Open

NAC10

This course explores various arts disciplines (dance, drama, installation and performance art, media arts, music, storytelling, utilitarian or functional art, visual arts), giving students the opportunity to create, present, and analyse art works, including integrated art works/productions, that explore or reflect First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives and cultures. Students will examine the interconnected relationships between art forms and individual and cultural identities, histories, values, protocols, and ways of knowing and being. They will demonstrate innovation as they learn and apply art-related concepts, methods, and conventions, and acquire skills that are transferable beyond the classroom. Students will use the creative process and responsible practices to explore solutions to creative arts challenges.

Prerequisite: None

A. ARTISTIC EXPRESSION AND FIRST NATIONS, MÉTIS, AND INUIT WORLD VIEWS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The People and the Land:** demonstrate an understanding of the spiritual interconnectedness of people, the land, and the natural world in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views, analysing how spiritual and personal connections to the land are expressed through various art forms and arts disciplines;
- A2. Identities:** demonstrate an understanding of the role of spiritual, individual, gender, and collective identities in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views, analysing how identity is expressed through various art forms and arts disciplines;
- A3. Self-Determination and Nationhood:** demonstrate an understanding of the role of sovereignty, self-governance, and nationhood in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views, analysing how self-determination is expressed through various art forms and arts disciplines.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The People and the Land

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** analyse how First Nations, Métis, and Inuit arts disciplines are connected to the traditional territories now called Canada, drawing on evidence from a variety of regions and cultures (*e.g., chiselled rock and rock paintings depict events that happened where the rocks are located; styles of dance are often identified regionally as Northern, Southern, West Coast, East Coast; oral stories and songs often address the land directly or describe particular territories; the materials used in mask making reflect the region with which the mask maker is associated; floral designs in traditional Métis beadwork and silk-thread embroidery often refer to local Indigenous ecological knowledge; Inuit drumming and singing styles vary according to their specific geographic origins*)

Sample questions: “What is the significance of using regionally specific material in First Nations, Métis, or Inuit art works?” “In what regional ecosystem might you find the indigenous plants required to make a sweetgrass basket?” “Why should you seek advice from a local Elder, Métis Senator, knowledge keeper, or

knowledge holder when utilizing materials from the land in your art works?” “What is Indigenous land-based education? How might land-based teaching concepts, such as a connection to the natural world located within traditional territories, enhance your knowledge, skills, and attitude as you explore arts disciplines from First Nations, Métis, or Inuit perspectives?”

- A1.2** identify and explain a variety of recurrent symbols and themes related to the land and the natural world in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art forms (*e.g., symbols: the circle, the infinity sign, the inukshuk, trees, birds, antlers, Earth, the moon, the sun, feathers, flowers, water; themes: the impact of climate change, the importance of responsible land use, the sacredness of the land, the spiritual connection between the people and the land*), drawing on evidence from several different art works/productions to analyse how spiritual and personal connections to the land inform artistic expression

Sample questions: “What do the symbols included in the Native Women’s Trail of Tears Quilt represent? What themes are expressed in the individual quilt blocks?” “What is the

main theme of *The Jerusalem Series*, by Daphne Odjig? Why do you think an Israeli airline commissioned an Odawa/Potawatomi artist to depict the holy city of Jerusalem? How do the prints reflect a First Nations perspective of the land?" "What specific connections does Susan Point's *Cedar Connection* carving make between the land, sea, and sky and traditional Salish culture? In your opinion, how does the work express a spiritual dimension?" "How does Mathew Nuqingaq use symbols of Inuit land in his silver jewellery design?"

A1.3 analyse the relationship between human society and the natural world expressed by precontact First Nations and Inuit artists and early Métis artists, drawing on evidence from several different art forms (e.g., *Tsimshian carved red cedar totem poles connected family history with symbolic animal forms; an Inuit qilaut, or caribou-skin drum, was played to accompany drum dancing at gatherings to mark the changing of the seasons*)

Sample questions: "How were the seal and the caribou viewed in Inuit culture? How did Inuit use the different parts of a variety of animals in traditional art forms? How did this use reflect the values of reciprocity and mutual respect?" "How did song and ritual play an important part in communicating reciprocity and mutual respect to the spirit of the caribou?"

A1.4 identify and explain various ways in which First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists are reclaiming a personal connection to the land and/or the natural world through their work, drawing on evidence from specific art works (e.g., *Amanda Strong draws a parallel between her own existence and the tenacious but fragile life of the honey bee in her 2009 short film Honey for Sale; Jordan Bennett establishes links to the land by including walnut, oak, and spruce in his 2010 interactive sculptural sound work Turning Tables; in his collaborative art project Anishnaabensag Biimskowebshkigewag (Native Kids Ride Bikes), Dylan Miner uses the bicycle to evoke the Red River cart, symbolizing Métis migrations across illegitimate national borders*)

Sample questions: "How does the work of Inuk artist Kenojuak Ashevak demonstrate the connection of Inuit, both past and present, to the land?" "How did Terry Haines use video documentation to reflect the link between land and cultural survival in his 2013 work *Coyote X*?" "How would you describe Métis artist Dylan Miner's *Anishnaabensag Biimskowebshkigewag (Native Kids Ride Bikes)* project within the context

of environmental sustainability? How does the art work reclaim a connection to traditional migratory practices?"

A2. Identities

By the end of this course, students will:

A2.1 analyse the role of spiritual identity in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views, drawing on evidence from several different art forms and arts disciplines (e.g., *Inuit drum dancing expresses the spiritual nature of the performer's identity; beliefs about transformation between spirit forms, or identities, are embodied in copper and silver carvings of birds with human features; radiating lines incorporated in stone and bone carvings represent the connections between humans and spiritual forces, conveying the spiritual nature of humankind; a variety of art forms use circles to represent the interconnection of the human life cycle and other natural life cycles and to remind individuals to strive for spiritual balance in all aspects of their existence; symbolic spiritual helpers, such as the thunderbird, are depicted in the art forms of many cultures*)

Sample questions: "What is spiritual identity? How does your experience of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art forms help you understand the concept of spiritual identity? Why do you think art is central to the expression of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit spiritual identities?" "Why is the circle a dominant symbol in First Nations cultural art forms? What other symbols represent the belief, prevalent in many First Nations world views, that all of creation is connected to a spiritual life force?"

A2.2 describe various ways in which materials, colours, and symbols are used in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art forms to express aspects of individual and/or collective identity, analysing some regional and cultural similarities and differences (e.g., *materials: members of the Bear clan may use bear hide and claws in clothing designs; the use of birch bark and/or birch bark designs in various art forms may represent the artist's affiliation with a Woodland nation; the incorporation of whale bone into traditional regalia may reflect the artist's Arctic or Northwest origins; colours: colour variations and weaving styles are used in Métis sashes to represent specific families and communities; blue is associated with women in traditional Plains hide paintings; specific colours used in beadwork are associated with the wearer's unique and inherent gifts; symbols: arrows, serpents, floral designs, land formations, and water signs often reflect the elements and characteristics of an individual's spirit name*)

Sample questions: “How do symbols used by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists differ from region to region across Canada? How might you explain some of these differences?” “Why do the sun, moon, stars, fish, bears, and turtles play a significant role in many First Nations cultural expressions?” “What cultural or spiritual significance did the First Nation presenter assign to the spirit colours of his or her regalia? How did the regalia reflect the presenter’s cultural identity?” “What materials were traditionally used by Inuit artists and how are they similar to or different from materials used by contemporary Inuit artists? Why do walrus, whales, seals, and birds play a significant role in many Inuit cultural expressions?”

A2.3 explain how the form, materials, and/or techniques used in various First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art works/productions have been selected by the artist(s) to express a perspective or communicate a message about gender and gender roles (e.g., *describe the techniques used in Shelley Niro’s 1991 photographic series Mohawks in Beehives to document an act of personal empowerment by Mohawk women; explain how Kent Monkman uses the art form of landscape painting to explore concepts of sovereignty and territory while commenting on gender and two-spirited identities in works such as Trappers of Men*)

Sample questions: “What is a moccasin vamp? Why do you think this material was selected as a symbol of missing and murdered Indigenous women in the art installation *Walking with Our Sisters*? How did social media play a role in the production of the work?”*

A2.4 describe how various First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists use media arts to express and support Indigeneity, collective and/or cultural identity, decolonization, and cultural continuity (e.g., *Métis/Algonquin filmmaker Michelle Latimer uses stop-motion animation to explore the individual search for identity within contemporary urban society from a First Nations perspective; Alderville First Nation poet Leanne Simpson collaboratively sets her poems and spoken-word narratives to music by Indigenous musicians to express what it means to live as an Anishinaabekwe; the travelling photographic exhibition Lost Identities: A Journey of Rediscovery invited members of various First Nations communities to symbolically repatriate the subjects of historical images by recording the names, locations, and details of the individuals and places represented; Inuit media art collective Isuma Productions uses high-definition video and*

wireless broadband to re-create cultural traditions as the expression of a distinctively Inuit perspective)

Sample questions: What does the term ‘decolonization’ mean in the context of art works/productions created by and/or for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit youth? What is the connection between decolonization and identity? What are some ways that media arts can be used to reclaim First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural identities and express a collective desire for decolonization?” “How do Nadya Kwandibens’ *Concrete Indians* photographic series and Terrance Houle’s photographic *Urban Indian Series* express aspects of contemporary urban Indigeneity?”

A3. Self-Determination and Nationhood

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 explain how the concepts of sovereignty, self-governance, and nationhood are expressed through a variety of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art forms (e.g., *with reference to peace pipes, wampum belts, Métis sashes, the Nunavut flag, Métis flags, the Eagle Staff, flag songs, ceremonial regalia, dance regalia*), analysing the purpose and function of these art forms in social policy and/or the representation of world views

Sample questions: “Did the introduction of the Nunavut flag unite the territory?” “How and when is a wampum belt used?” “How do nations differentiate themselves through art forms at powwows, intertribal gatherings, and Elder/youth gatherings?” “What are some historical interpretations of the Métis flag? How is the Métis flag used within Métis organizations and at rendezvous and annual general assemblies? “What does an Eagle Staff reveal about the nation that created it? Why does the Eagle Staff need a helper, or Eagle Staff carrier, to be present to enable the art form to perform its function? Why is this cultural expression of sovereignty referred to as a living spirit?”

A3.2 explain some consequences of various pieces of Canadian legislation for past and present First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural and artistic expressions of sovereignty and/or self-governance (e.g., *the Indian Act amendment of 1885 prohibited religious ceremonies and dances for Indians as defined by the Act; section 35(1) of the Constitution Act, 1982, recognizes First Nations, Métis, and Inuit as three separate groups of Indigenous peoples with unique heritages, languages, cultural practices, and spiritual beliefs;*

* Certain topics may trigger an emotional response due to the sensitivity of the subject matter. It may be necessary to provide or connect students with appropriate emotional supports.

Canadian intellectual property rights legislation, such as the Copyright Act, the Patent Act, and the Trade-marks Act, does not explicitly protect traditional knowledge expressed through First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art forms and arts disciplines)

Sample questions: “Why do you think legislation is needed to address the issue of misappropriation of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural knowledge, language, and traditions? How is this issue connected to artistic expression?” “What are some ways that legislation to protect cultural products and Indigenous knowledge might affect both Indigenous and non-Indigenous artists?” “How might current copyright law be shaped to better protect the unique traditions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists?”

B. CREATING AND PRESENTING

Note: In all aspects of this course, but particularly in learning connected with this strand, students must apply a clear understanding of the responsibilities that come with creating and presenting First Nations-, Métis-, or Inuit-focused art works and productions, including responsibilities related to respectful engagement with Indigenous peoples and Indigenous knowledge; ethics and engagement protocols; cultural appreciation and cultural appropriation; intellectual property; the use of materials, tools, and techniques; and presentation delivery.

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Creative Process:** apply the creative process individually and/or collaboratively to create art works, including integrated art works/productions, that draw on their exploration of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives to express their own personal world views, histories, or cultures;
- B2. Elements and Principles:** apply key elements and principles from various arts disciplines, as reflected in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art forms, when creating, modifying, and presenting art works, including integrated art works/productions;
- B3. Materials, Tools, Techniques, and Technologies:** use a variety of traditional and contemporary materials, tools, techniques, and technologies to create art works, including integrated art works/productions, that demonstrate creativity;
- B4. Presentation and Promotion:** present and promote art works, including integrated art works/productions, for a variety of purposes, respecting First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural protocols and using appropriate technologies and conventions.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** individually and/or collaboratively, use a variety of strategies (e.g., *brainstorming with a partner; talking with a mentor; using word webs and/or mind maps*) to generate ideas to address a creative challenge through exploration of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives

Sample questions: “How might your knowledge of First Nations, Métis, or Inuit cultures provide inspiration for your art work?” “Why is it necessary to consider more than one way of approaching a creative challenge?” “What are some challenges and benefits of using a collaborative process to generate ideas?” “How do the feelings you experienced in this natural setting help you make personal connections with First Nations, Métis, or Inuit perspectives

on the human relationship to the land? How might you reflect those feelings in your art work?”

- B1.2** individually and/or collaboratively, use exploration, input, and reflection to develop, revise, and refine plans for art works, including integrated art works/productions, that explore or reflect First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives (e.g., *use a think-pair-share strategy to explore ideas and select one for their art work; use a checklist to develop their plan; reflect on the input of their peers and revise their plan as appropriate; use a graphic organizer to refine the elements of their plan*)

Sample questions: “What steps are involved in developing a plan to create integrated art works? Why is it important to follow all of these steps? What might happen if you do not reflect carefully on the feasibility of your plan?”

B1.3 individually and/or collaboratively, use the appropriate stages of the creative process to produce and present preliminary art works, including integrated art works/productions, in response to themes or world views associated with First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (*e.g., a work that integrates drama and music to explore the theme of decolonization, a painting or mixed-media work that expresses a connection to or concern about the environment*), and revise their works on the basis of peer- and self-assessment (*e.g., present a preliminary version of their work to a group of peers and make notes on their response; reflect on the applicability of a peer critique before revising their work*)

Sample questions: “Which arts discipline or disciplines might you use to express your connection to or concern about the environment?” “In what ways did the feedback of your peers affect your own assessment of your work?”

B2. Elements and Principles

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 select and apply some common First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural images and colours (*e.g., the eagle, the coyote, the infinity symbol, the circle, purple and white representing the Haudenosaunee Nation, red representing the Indigenous people of Turtle Island, blue and white representing the Métis Nation*) when creating art works, including integrated art works/productions, and explain their symbolic meaning

Sample questions: “Why do you think animal imagery is common on First Nations flags? What might this reveal about a nation’s culture and/or history? What symbol might you use to reflect your own family history and culture on a flag?” “What character or role does the eagle have for many First Nations? What does the eagle represent in your own art work? Why did you choose it?” “What do the four colours of an Anishinaabe medicine wheel represent? How does the wheel embody the principles of relationship and balance? How can these principles be applied to a work of art?”

B2.2 select and apply elements and principles found in First Nations, Métis or Inuit art works from various arts disciplines to create art works of personal and/or cultural significance (*e.g., apply the elements of space and relationship from ceremonial dance to create a dance performance expressing their connection to the natural world or to their own cultural heritage; combine the elements of line and space found in Haida painted art with*

the principle of hybridization from Métis decorative arts to produce a multimedia work that reflects their individual identity)

Sample questions: “When you listen to aspects of duration (beat, rhythm) in this recording of drumming, what images come to mind? What theme could you express by combining drumming and the images it evokes within your chosen art form?”

B2.3 modify the elements and/or principles of an existing art work/production to acknowledge First Nations, Métis, or Inuit perspectives (*e.g., re-create a scene from a film, changing the point of view to reflect the perspective of a First Nation character, and record the modified scene on video; modify a linear design to create an art work reflecting circularity and interconnectedness*), and compare the effects of the original and modified works

Sample questions: “What was your reaction to this art work the first time you experienced it? How do you think your changes will affect the way the audience reacts to the new work?”

B3. Materials, Tools, Techniques, and Technologies

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 use media/materials, tools, and/or techniques associated with traditional First Nations, Métis, or Inuit art forms (*e.g., media/materials: sweetgrass, deer hide, moose hide, glass beads, bone, sinew, rocks, birch bark, porcupine quills, soapstone; tools: scrapers, uluit, awls, looms; techniques: finger weaving, moose hair tufting, carving, plaiting, beading, biting*) to create an art work/production that demonstrates creativity

Sample questions: “How do you determine which materials or techniques to use in order to express your theme or perspective in a unique, creative manner?” “What criteria can you use to determine whether your art work demonstrates creativity?”

B3.2 combine media/materials, tools, and techniques associated with contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art forms (*e.g., media/materials: digital photography, videography, film, flip books, acrylic paints, textiles, natural dyes/pigments, clay, paper, fabrics, found objects; tools: digital imaging technologies, sound technologies, the Internet; techniques: sewing, stop-motion animation, three-dimensional computer graphics, digital projection, pixilation*) to create an art work/production that demonstrates creativity

Sample questions: “What are some locally available materials that First Nations artists in your community use?” “What differences and/or similarities in materials and techniques can you identify between contemporary ‘formline’ and Woodlands styles of art? How might you use some of these materials or techniques in your own work?”

- B3.3** integrate tools, techniques, and/or technologies from more than one arts discipline to create an integrated art work/production that communicates a specific message about an issue affecting First Nations, Métis, or Inuit communities (e.g., *create a multimedia work inspired by Aboriginal title and treaty rights or Métis scrip challenges in Canada; create a performance piece about residential schools in Canada, using a digital video backdrop; incorporate music, sound, and poetry to produce a soundscape on the theme of First Nations, Métis, or Inuit and environmental issues*)

Sample questions: “What do you wish to communicate to your audience about your chosen topic? What arts disciplines will you draw on? Why do you think these are the most appropriate choices?”

B4. Presentation and Promotion

By the end of this course, students will:

- B4.1** apply current technologies to present integrated art works/productions (e.g., *add digitally designed lighting and music to enhance a dramatic presentation; present a virtual, interactive, and/or web-based version of a live project; present their work in a virtual gallery*)

Sample questions: “How can you use technology to support your message?” “Why can a presentation in a virtual gallery reach a broader audience than one in a traditional museum or gallery?”

- B4.2** apply appropriate standards, conventions, cultural protocols, and practices associated with the preparation, promotion, and presentation of art works, including integrated art works/productions, for a variety of purposes (e.g., *format works for presentation in a gallery or for inclusion in a portfolio; use the appropriate procedures and tools to promote a production, including posters, tickets, and programs; write an artist’s statement to accompany their work, acknowledging the First Nations, Métis, or Inuit artist(s) who inspired them; preface their art performance by acknowledging the traditional territory on which it is taking place; make an*

offering, provide a small gift, and/or say a prayer to honour all the elements used in the creation of an art work; ask an Elder, Métis Senator, local knowledge keeper, or local knowledge holder to open an art presentation with a smudge, a prayer, or remarks)

Sample questions: “How will you acknowledge the First Nation, Métis, or Inuit artist who inspired your work?” “How might you organize and present the work in your portfolio to highlight the First Nations, Métis, or Inuit perspectives that inform your artistic intent?” “How might you draw your audience’s attention to works by the artist who inspired your dance troupe’s production?” “What information do you need to determine the budget required to present your work in a school or community setting? What record-keeping techniques could you use to document the expenses incurred to present your work and/or income earned from the sale of your work?”

- B4.3** modify an art work/production to suit a target audience (e.g., *use volume, tone, accent, pace, gesture, and facial expression to reveal character to an audience of children; use direction of gaze to enhance the mood when performing a dance outdoors; use audio software to add sound effects for audience members with visual challenges*)

Sample questions: “How will you modify your dance troupe’s presentation so that elementary students will understand and appreciate the story or message?” “How does your choice of target audience influence the way you present and promote your work of art?”

C. FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of, and use proper terminology when referring to, elements, principles, and other key concepts related to various arts disciplines, as reflected in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art forms;
- C2. Themes and Influences:** demonstrate an understanding of past and present themes and influences associated with First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art making, as reflected in a variety of art works/productions;
- C3. Conventions and Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of conventions and responsible practices associated with various arts disciplines, and with art making within First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and apply these practices when experiencing, analysing, creating, and presenting art works/productions;
- C4. The Critical Analysis Process:** demonstrate an understanding of the critical analysis process by applying it to the study of art works/productions from various arts disciplines, including their own works, the works of their peers, and works by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** use appropriate terminology related to elements, principles, and other key concepts when creating, analysing, or presenting various types of art works, including art works/productions exploring or reflecting First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives (e.g., *use appropriate terminology when designing a flag that reflects their own cultural heritage, when describing their initial reaction to a multimedia work that incorporates Inuit throat singing, when analysing the use of music to enhance a digital display of Métis floral designs; design a word game using terms related to the art traditions of various First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, such as “Métis rug hooking”, “peace tree”, and “thunderbird”*)
- C1.2** demonstrate an understanding of elements, principles, and other key concepts associated with various arts disciplines, as reflected in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art forms (e.g., *explain the difference between sacred and social dances in Haudenosaunee culture; describe the techniques of folding and biting used to create Ojibwe birch bark designs; describe the syncretic structure of Métis fiddle music and explain how the*

form differs from First Nations and non-Indigenous fiddle music; compare the aesthetic features and physical design of an Ojibwe tikiagan and an Inuit amauti; identify examples of how Inuit artists incorporate the natural contours, lines, and cracks of the bone or stone they are carving within their artistic compositions; explain how the selection of colour, shape, and space in Haida painted works illustrates a world perspective that reflects harmony with nature, among people, and within individuals), and identify those terms that are common to more than one arts discipline or cultural group (e.g., ceremonial dancing, dance regalia, cradleboard teachings, Woodland designs, beadwork, honour beats in drumming, thematic and iterative styles of storytelling)

- C1.3** compare approaches to the creative process within various arts disciplines, as reflected in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art forms, using appropriate vocabulary (e.g., *with reference to inspiration in clothing or regalia design and oral storytelling, the exploration and manipulation of natural materials when planning the contours of sculptures and utilitarian art forms, experimentation in dance and visual arts, presentation in media arts and music*)

Sample questions: “What connections can you make between how a beadwork artist chooses motifs and patterns to adorn a piece of clothing and how a storyteller selects certain words and phrases to reiterate throughout a story?” “What do First Nations, Métis, and Inuit storytellers need to consider when developing their approach to a traditional storytelling?” “How do natural materials influence the type of sculptures produced by contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists? What examples can you identify to support your explanation?”

C2. Themes and Influences

By the end of this course, students will:

C2.1 describe, on the basis of research, themes in the work of some past and/or present First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists, including artists whose body of work incorporates more than one art form (e.g., *prepare and deliver a short presentation on themes explored by artists such as Rebecca Belmore, Buffy Sainte-Marie, Tomson Highway, Nadia Myre, Archer Pechawis, Teharihulen Michel Savard, Tanya Tagaq*)

Sample questions: “How has the artist’s choice of media changed over the course of his or her career? What connection can you make between the artist’s choice of media and the theme of the work?”

C2.2 describe, on the basis of research, some past and present political, socio-economic, and environmental influences on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art making (e.g., *colonization and decolonization; assimilation; missionary evangelism; historical migration and settlement patterns; rural–urban migration; the forced relocation of Inuit communities; funding or lack of funding for community-based cultural and art programs; the commodification of Inuit art by the West Baffin Eskimo Co-operative; globalization; the depletion of natural resources; the European Union’s ban on the trade of all marine mammal products, including seal and whale products*)

Sample questions: “What information can you gather about the influence of both First Nations and European cultures in Métis art works, dance, music, and/or clothing designs?” “What effect does lack of financial support for community-based arts programs have on First Nations communities?” “In what ways have First Nations, Métis, and Inuit entrepreneurs influenced how traditional art forms are introduced into the global marketplace?” “How has the market economy affected the development and growth of traditional Inuit art forms?”

C2.3 describe, on the basis of research, some past and present technological and cultural influences on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art making (e.g., *printmaking technologies, photography, film and digital video, popular culture, shared and hybrid cultural contexts, the dissemination of European-designed goods, square dancing and accordion music introduced to the Arctic by Scottish whalers*)

Sample questions: “How have advances in technology affected the choice of forms, materials, and techniques used in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art works/productions? How have they facilitated the dissemination of art?” “While media and mainstream art circles coined the name ‘the Indian Group of Seven’ to refer to a group of First Nations artists, the artists themselves referred to their group as the Professional Native Indian Artists Incorporation. What difference is expressed by the two names? What sociocultural influences can you identify in the works of these artists?” “How did ancient Japanese printmaking traditions influence Inuit printmaking?”

C3. Conventions and Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 identify and appropriately apply conventions associated with experiencing various types of art works/productions, including works from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., *outline a protocol for etiquette in a gallery, museum, concert hall, theatre, or gathering, and create a poster illustrating this protocol*)

Sample questions: “Is it appropriate to clap after viewing a ceremonial dance? Why, or why not?” “What types of behaviour can detract from other listeners’ experience of an oral storytelling?” “When listening to an oral story or song, what responsibility do you have to be part of the experience?”

C3.2 identify, on the basis of research, some legal, ethical, and culturally sensitive practices related to various arts disciplines, and apply these practices when analysing, creating, presenting, and/or promoting art works/productions (e.g., *seek permission before reproducing copyrighted material and provide appropriate credit; identify the differences between cultural appreciation and cultural exploitation, and avoid cultural appropriation in their own art works; conduct research on evolving Canadian copyright standards with respect to new media and implications for the arts; seek the views of local Elders, Métis Senators, knowledge keepers, and knowledge holders when*

exploring First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art forms; follow appropriate cultural protocols and practices when sourcing, gathering, or handling traditional materials and artefacts; obtain permission when working with cultural designs, stories, and/or imagery; acknowledge the gifts of material from the natural environment; treat sacred/ceremonial objects and objects of cultural significance respectfully and responsibly)

Sample questions: “Why is it important to consider cultural sensitivity when analysing and/or promoting First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art works?” “Is it ethical for artists to borrow from the work of others? Why, or why not?” “What respectful practices and protocols should you follow when using this traditional art-making technique?” “What copyright considerations did you need to address in your art work?” “How can you appropriately acknowledge the gifts of natural materials used in your art?”

C3.3 demonstrate an understanding of safe and conscientious work practices associated with various arts disciplines, and apply these practices when engaged in the creative process (*e.g., follow instruction manuals and/or the teacher’s instructions when using new tools and technologies; show consideration for other students sharing the same work space; develop classroom rules and expectations through small-group discussions; read warning labels on containers; wear appropriate protective equipment*)

Sample questions: “Why should you avoid using spray paint in a classroom?” “What organizations or unions are concerned with the safety of artists in your chosen media? Do they have any specific safety guidelines that apply to your work?” “How do you respectfully dispose of traditional materials? How does this give back to Earth?”

C3.4 identify some environmental issues associated with the arts, and apply environmentally responsible practices when creating and presenting art works, including integrated art works/productions (*e.g., dispose of paint containers in an environmentally responsible way; source environmentally friendly materials; recycle materials appropriately; use natural materials only in the amount needed and only if they have been sustainably and responsibly collected*)

Sample questions: “How can art and art making affect the environment?” “How can you obtain environmentally responsible materials for your art work?” “What are some ways that an individual artist can contribute to environmental conservation or protection?” “Where does

our waste water end up? What might be some consequences of pouring a toxic liquid down the drain?”

C4. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

C4.1 assess and communicate their initial reaction to art works/productions from a variety of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures and arts disciplines (*e.g., describe their initial response to Inuit throat singing; explain their interpretation of the body movements and hand gestures of Tsimshian dancers acting out a tale; identify an aspect of a Dene chant, a work by Nelson Tagaona or Tanya Tagaq, or a piece of Métis fiddle music that evoked an emotional response; discuss their reaction to an article of fashion that appropriates a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit design without consent*), using various strategies and modes of communication (*e.g., a small-group or class discussion, a placemat exercise, a blog, a journal*)

Sample questions: “What cultural insights did you gain from the art forms demonstrated by the Métis presenter?” “In what ways does the floral beadwork or quillwork on traditional clothing remind you of contemporary clothing designs? How has this influenced your perception of the contributions of Métis women to art and art forms?” “The creative directors of the House of Valentino asked artist Christi Belcourt for permission to base a fashion line on her painting *Water Song*. What do you think the art work and the clothes express about the interconnectedness of all living things? How does the theme of interconnectedness make you feel? What do you think the process demonstrates about respectful collaboration?”

C4.2 describe various ways in which First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists are incorporating new technologies into traditional art forms (*e.g., Christi Belcourt’s *Water Song* uses raised paint dots to represent beadwork; A Tribe Called Red’s “Electric Pow Wow Drum” combines techno and traditional beats; Inuk artist Tanya Tagaq combines traditional throat singing and video projection in her performances; Ruben Anton Komangapik embeds QR codes into some of his art works in order to share stories*), and analyse the impact of this innovation on how the work is experienced

Sample questions: “What are some issues involved in combining traditional art forms with contemporary technologies and tools?” “What are some innovative ways that contemporary artists are using interactive technologies to tell First Nations, Métis, and Inuit stories? How effective do you find these forms of presentation?”

C4.3 identify, on the basis of examination, the elements and principles used in various art works/productions by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists, and analyse their effects (e.g., *Allen Sapp uses the principle of balance to create an impression of equal importance between human figures and the landscape in his paintings; Elisapie Isaac incorporates folk and pop rhythms into songs designed to connect generations of Inuit; Susan Aglukark incorporates contemporary country and pop rhythms and tempo into melodies based on Inuit folk music to make songs based on her life that her listeners find relevant to their own experiences*)

Sample questions: “How does the artist use colour to convey a particular mood in this painting?” “How have the artists created an area of emphasis within this quilt?” “How does this artist embed Indigenous language and ancestry into the song lyrics to promote cultural understanding through music?”

C4.4 identify and reflect on the qualities of their own art works/productions and the works of others (e.g., *using a journal, a blog, discussions with peers and/or Elders, Métis Senators, knowledge keepers, or knowledge holders*), and evaluate the effectiveness of these works

Sample questions: “What aspects of this art work do you think appropriately reflect a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit perspective? Why?” “When you reflect on your own completed art work/production, would you do anything differently? Why, or why not?” “What technical, acoustic, or expressive aspects of this art work might you change to accentuate its message?”

D. ART AND SOCIETY

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Art Forms and Society:** demonstrate an understanding of how past and present First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art forms reflect the societies and periods in which they were created;
- D2. Promoting Renewal, Healing, Reconciliation, and Dialogue:** demonstrate an understanding of how art making and art works can promote renewal and healing in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities and reconciliation and dialogue with non-Indigenous communities;
- D3. Connections beyond the Classroom:** describe the skills developed through creating, presenting, and analysing art works that explore First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives, including integrated art works/productions, and identify various opportunities to pursue artistic endeavours beyond the classroom.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Art Forms and Society

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** analyse various ways in which precontact First Nations and Inuit material culture and early Métis material culture reflected cultural, artistic, and/or spiritual expression, drawing on evidence from several different utilitarian art forms (*e.g., bannerstones, which were used as counterweights in spear-throwing devices called atlatls, held ceremonial significance; burial objects that were intended to reflect the social status of the deceased also had ornamental characteristics; Inuit carvings of animals were used in games and for storytelling and shamanic purposes; Inuit snow goggles made of bone or ivory were both functionally innovative and aesthetically sophisticated; horn rattles were used in Haudenosaunee ceremonies, social songs, and dances; paintings on animal hides were used to illustrate and record significant events and to promote healing*)

Sample questions: “What are some examples of utilitarian objects that demonstrate spirituality and/or a reverence for beauty?” “What do early buffalo hide paintings tell us about artistic and technological elements of Plains culture?” “Do you think that utilitarian objects can be considered artistic creations? Why, or why not? Can utilitarian objects be considered historical documentation? Why, or why not?”

- D1.2** reflect on and communicate how their experience of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art works depicting social relationships (*e.g., intergenerational relationships, clans, kinship, ancestral connections*) has influenced their own beliefs and values with respect to family relationships and community in contemporary society (*e.g., with reference to the role of grandparents, extended family connections, child-parent relationships*)

- D1.3** analyse various social and/or political messages communicated by the work of emerging and established First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists (*e.g., Carl Beam’s mixed-media work The North American Iceberg links the past and present by depicting the intersection of historical and contemporary resistance to colonialist policies; Alanis Obomsawin’s film Kanehsatake: 270 Years of Resistance gives voice to a First Nation perspective on the Oka land dispute; David Garneau’s painting series Cowboys and Indians (and Métis?) promotes the representation of Métis identity; Alethea Arnaquq-Baril’s documentary film Angry Inuk brings the voice of Inuit into the debate over seal product bans in Europe; the ballet Going Home Star – Truth and Reconciliation was commissioned by the Royal Winnipeg Ballet to convey the Indian residential school experience through dance and music*), drawing on their knowledge of the social context within which a specific art work was produced

Sample questions: “What kinds of social or political concerns drive an artist’s practice?” “What economic events or conditions prompted Inuk filmmaker Ruby Arngna’naaq’s video series *The Money Stories*? What do you think the artist wanted to communicate about the introduction of capitalism into her community?” “In what way is Sonny Assu’s 2015 work *Gone Copper! Giving It All Away* political? Why did the artist choose copper?” “What are some of the concerns that Lawrence Paul Yuxweluptun’s painting *The One Percent* alludes to?” “How does David Garneau’s series of paintings *Cowboys and Indians (and Métis?)* make use of satirical social and political messages to explore Métis identity?”

- D1.4** identify various types of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art performance (e.g., *storytelling, oration, dance*), explain how these works are connected to cultural tradition and to other theatrical forms (e.g., *drama, musical theatre, improvisation*), and analyse their contributions to society (e.g., *with reference to aesthetic experience; skills development; the exchange of cultural ideas; the promotion of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, values, traditions, and perspectives*)

Sample questions: “The Centre for Indigenous Theatre was founded as the Native Theatre School in Ontario in 1974. What was the motivation? How are the ideas expressed in contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit theatre art and performance similar to, or different from, ideas expressed at that time?” “How does the Indigenous dance company Kaha:wi Dance Theatre integrate cultural elements into dance, theatrical performance, music, and design? What contribution do the performances make to contemporary society?” “What was the motivation for establishing the circus performance collective Artcirq? In what specific ways does its programming immerse youth performers in circus arts, Inuit traditions, and various performance styles?”

- D1.5** identify various forums for developing and sharing contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art forms (e.g., *online music-sharing platforms, music podcasts, videos uploaded to the Internet, personal websites, sound clouds, film and media arts festivals, music contests and awards, exhibitions, collaborations between artists and professionals such as fashion designers, commissioned work for corporations and publicly owned institutions*), and explain how these forums can support the expression of aspirations for sovereignty and self-governance

Sample questions: “In what specific ways do the Ontario Arts Council and the Aboriginal Arts Office of the Canada Council for the Arts support First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists?” “How did the 2011 exhibition *Decolonize Me* address the issue of colonization and First Nations, Métis, and Inuit aspirations for sovereignty or self-governance? Why do you think the choice of a mainstream, publicly funded gallery as a forum to share this work might be particularly effective?”

D2. Promoting Renewal, Healing, Reconciliation, and Dialogue

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1** analyse the role of art in promoting renewal and healing within First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities, drawing on evidence from several different art forms and arts disciplines (e.g., *graphic designs can express collective identity; song lyrics may articulate ideas about healing; public murals promote community pride; contemporary seamstresses use traditional sewing methods and designs to produce sealskin clothing that reasserts the value of Inuit culture; new and evolving art forms, such as hip hop, hair tattoos, and body art, offer modes of cultural self-expression to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit youth; redesigning public space to reflect the traditional territory and people of a particular location supports cultural renewal*)

Sample questions: “How does Jingle Dress dancing promote spiritual healing?” “How does storytelling at urban festivals encourage cultural renewal?” “Clothing that incorporates cultural references into contemporary style is often a popular sale item at powwows, gatherings, and rendezvous. How does this type of clothing promote cultural exchange and cultural pride? What types of cultural information does a clothing design reveal about the artist and the wearer?” “How does the revitalization of tattooing among Inuit women promote the exploration of history and sustain community connections?”

- D2.2** analyse the role of art in supporting reconciliation and justice for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities within Canadian society, drawing on evidence from several different art forms and arts disciplines (e.g., *explain the connection between Inuit storytelling for children and the principle of reconciliation; analyse how art installations that preserve First Nations, Métis, or Inuit stories can support reconciliation, drawing on specific examples; evaluate how multimedia art works that focus on justice and reconciliation can*

bring communities together and raise awareness about the legacy of the residential school system in Canada; describe some specific ways in which First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art works challenge cultural stereotypes; compare a mainstream perspective on a particular Canadian historical event with the perspective expressed in a specific work by a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit artist, analysing how the work challenges conventional interpretations of the event)

Sample questions: “Why do you think First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists refer to a need to ‘reclaim’ images of themselves?” “How might an artist, community, or nation challenge stereotypes through art? What examples can you give?” “How does Carey Newman’s large-scale art installation *Witness Blanket* demonstrate truth telling, the preservation of stories, and the promotion of reconciliation?”

D2.3 identify, on the basis of research, various legal, ethical, financial, and cultural implications of Canadian policies related to the repatriation of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural articles, analysing the historical and social context of these policies (e.g., with reference to museum inventories; public access to cultural objects with historical, ceremonial, and spiritual significance; the treatment of construction and excavation sites)

Sample questions: “What are some copyright and ownership issues associated with the artistic expressions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures?” “How did museums amass large inventories of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural objects? What actions are First Nations, Métis and Inuit groups, communities, and governments taking to retrieve and repatriate sacred and ceremonial articles and cultural objects from museums?”

D2.4 compare various community, regional, national, and global responses to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art (e.g., with reference to the inclusion or exclusion of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art works in exhibitions and catalogues; the critical attention paid to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art works/productions from different regions), analysing the role of art in bridging divergent cultural perspectives and promoting dialogue

Sample questions: “What are some generational differences in the responses of art audiences to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art works/productions? How do you explain these differences?” “In what ways can experiencing First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art build a bridge of understanding between Indigenous

and non-Indigenous audiences?” “How did the decision of a major web browser to feature a doodle honouring the work of Kenojuak Ashevak on her birthday provide a learning opportunity for both Indigenous and non-Indigenous individuals?” “What impact did the choice of an inukshuk as an emblem of the 2010 Winter Olympic Games in Vancouver have? What were some issues and consequences arising from the choice?”

D3. Connections beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 identify skills, character traits, and work habits that are developed through the processes of creating, analysing, presenting, promoting, and experiencing art works/productions that explore or reflect First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives (e.g., knowledge related to cultural proficiency and cultural safety, creative problem-solving skills, critical analysis skills, the ability to express themselves visually and orally, the ability to work collaboratively and independently), and explain how they can be applied outside the classroom (e.g., identify ways to apply their cooperative work habits in family contexts; describe how their understanding of cultural protocols can be applied in community settings; explain how they can use their analytical skills in a part-time job or volunteer position)

Sample question: “What problem-solving skills have you learned in this course that you can apply in your part-time job or volunteer position?”

D3.2 identify and explore arts-related careers and secondary and postsecondary pathways that reflect their interests and skills (e.g., create a list of postsecondary arts programs related to their interests; conduct online research to determine the skills and experience required for careers in advertising, animation, art therapy, fashion design, graphic design; create a personal skills inventory and compare it to the skills required in their field of interest; hold mock interviews for a position in the arts and culture industry)

Sample questions: “Which local First Nations, Métis, or Inuit artists work in an area of interest to you? How might you approach them to request an information interview?” “What grants, loans, and apprenticeship programs are available to support artists in starting or expanding small business ventures?”

D3.3 identify, on the basis of research, careers that support the development and promotion of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art locally, regionally, and nationally (*e.g., art auctioneer, artistic director, curator, educator, professor, graphic designer, website developer*), and compare the skills required in those careers

Sample questions: “What are some ways that the artistic director of a contemporary dance company could promote the work of emerging First Nations, Métis, and Inuit artists? What specific skills would he or she need to do so?” “What skills do curators and professors of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit art share? In what ways do their skills differ?”

D3.4 identify and evaluate opportunities to become engaged and gain experience in artistic and cultural endeavours beyond the classroom (*e.g., helping to design, create, and put up decorations for community plays, exhibitions, or festivals; designing posters for a variety of events; volunteering at a local arts-related organization; conducting research on arts-appreciation opportunities in their community and creating a list of the most relevant ones*)

Sample questions: “What are some activities that support and promote the work of local artists?” “What opportunities can you identify to become involved in artistic endeavours in the school or community?” “In what specific ways might you use an arts event as an opportunity to raise funds to help promote and present future events?”